Judge Somiranao Guro Dimnatang

(1956-2005)

There are lives that never seek attention yet change everything they touch. Municipal Circuit Trial Court (MCTC) Presiding Judge Somiranao Guro Dimnatang, lived one of those lives.

- Lawyer
- Administrator (1984-1986)
- Presiding Judge (1991-2005)

Notability

- Appointed as Administrator of Philippine Pilgrimage Authority (PHILPA), then the primary national agency responsible for the official annual Muslim pilgrimage (Hajj)

Known for

- Presiding Judge of MCTC Baloi-Pantar-Tagoloan, Lanao del Norte (1991-2005)
- Vice President – Mindanao, Philippine Trial Judges League, Inc. (2003-2005)
- Twenty-five (25) years in public service

A proud Maranao with roots in Buadi-Amaloy, Masiu, Lanao del Sur. He graduated in A.B. Political Science from Mindanao State University (MSU)-Marawi and earned his law degree from Manuel L. Quezon University.

What makes his accomplishment even more remarkable is that **he did not review for the Bar exam**. He graduated in October 1979 and took the Bar exam in November 1979. **He passed the Bar exam on his first take** and signed the Roll of Attorneys on May 9, 1980.

In 1980, he became the Legal Consultant in the Office of the Mindanao State University (MSU) President. In 1982-1983, he was the Jr. Executive Assistant in the Office of the Prime Minister. In 1984-1986, he was appointed as

Administrator of Philippine Pilgrimage Authority (PHILPA), then the primary national agency responsible for the official annual Muslim pilgrimage (Hajj). In 1988-1990, he worked in the House of Representatives as the Chief, Legislative Staff Officer in the Office of Congressman Abdullah Dimaporo. In 1991-2005, he was appointed as the **Presiding Judge of Municipal Circuit Trial Court (MCTC) Baloi-Pantar-Tagoloan, Lanao del Norte.** In 2003-2005, he served as the Vice President for Mindanao in the Philippine Trial Judges League, Inc. (PTJLI).

Birthplace – Masiu, Lanao del Sur

Heritage – Maranao, with ancestral roots in Buadi-Amaloy, Masiu, Lanao del Sur

Nationality – Filipino

Education –

- A.B. Political Science, Mindanao State University (MSU)-Marawi
- Bachelor of Laws, Manuel L. Quezon University

Spouse – Hadja Salma Macapundag Pangandaman Maca-alin Dimnatang

Religion – Islam

Early Life

Judge Somiranao Guro Dimnatang was born in 1956 in the municipality of Masiu in the province of Lanao del Sur. He was the eldest son of Hadji Dimnatang Guiling and Hadja Rakima Guro.

Education and Legal Credentials

He graduated in A.B. Political Science from Mindanao State University (MSU)-Marawi. When he decided to pursue law, he headed to Manila and enrolled at the Manuel L. Quezon University, an institution with a track record of producing young professionals and legal practitioners.

In October 1979, he completed his Bachelor of Laws degree. The following month came the 1979 Philippine Bar Examination. Despite being one of the most

demanding licensure exams in the country, he took the Bar exam without enrolling in a review center and passed the Bar exam on his first take.

Government Service

Judge Somiranao Guro Dimnatang became the Legal Consultant in the Office of the Mindanao State University (MSU) President and later on the Jr. Executive Assistant in the Office of the Prime Minister. He was appointed as Administrator of Philippine Pilgrimage Authority (PHILPA), then the primary national agency responsible for the official annual Muslim pilgrimage (Hajj). He worked in the House of Representatives as the Chief, Legislative Staff Officer in the Office of Congressman Abdullah Dimaporo. He was appointed as the **Presiding Judge of Municipal Circuit Trial Court (MCTC) Baloi-Pantar-Tagoloan, Lanao del Norte.**

Organizational Leadership

He served as the Vice President for Mindanao in the Philippine Trial Judges League, Inc. (PTJLI) in 2003-2005.

Legacy

Judge Somiranao Guro Dimnatang's tireless and selfless dedication to duties is worthy of commendation and a veritable legacy of devotion that continuously inspires the Philippine Trial Judges League, Inc. (PTJLI) to strive for Judicial Excellence.

Judge Dimnatang was known to his family as generous and deeply passionate about his work. To his friends and colleagues, he was kind, respectful and humble. He was a man of unparalleled integrity. He believed in always doing the right thing. He was a family man, a good husband and an amazing father. Additionally, he began efforts in the construction of a Mosque in Balulang, Cagayan de Oro City and Buadi-Amaloy, Masiu, Lanao del Sur, reflecting his commitment not only to justice but also to faith and community development.

He sometimes commutes in going to his court in Baloi, Lanao del Norte from his home in Cagayan de Oro City. He owned a car but sometimes chose not to use it. His Branch Clerk of Court just picks him up in a bus station in Iligan City and

they will go to MCTC, Baloi, Lanao del Norte to attend the day's scheduled hearing. He was one of the few government officials who consistently chose to live a modest life, despite his position affording far more comfortable privileges.

He faced life's challenges with courage and grace, never letting them define him. His ability to stay positive and hopeful, even in the face of adversity, was truly inspiring. He is a reflection of the moral compass that everyone must faithfully adhere to.

Judge Somiranao Guro Dimnatang will be remembered for his integrity, humility, and unwavering dedication to the justice system and to the community he faithfully served.